

Executive Summary

Morocco to U.S. Import & Distribution Business

Business Overview

The business will establish a **U.S.-based importing and distribution company specializing in premium Moroccan products**. The initial launch will focus on two products from an established Moroccan supplier whose product quality has already been evaluated: **virgin olive oil** for cooking and **cosmetic-grade argan oil** for hair and skincare. The strategy is to launch small, validate U.S. demand and unit economics, and then scale into a broader Moroccan food and beauty portfolio.

Business & Import Structure

A U.S. **LLC** will operate as the importer and distributor, supported by an EIN, business bank account, bookkeeping, product liability insurance, a customs broker, and appropriate regulatory/compliance specialists. Initially, products will preferably be **bottled, labeled, and packaged in Morocco** and imported as finished goods. Supplier documentation should include Certificates of Analysis, ingredients, manufacturing records, batch/lot traceability, testing, shelf-life information, and country-of-origin documentation.

Regulatory & Customs Compliance

Olive Oil: Address applicable FDA food-import requirements, including foreign facility registration, Foreign Supplier Verification Program (FSVP), Prior Notice, U.S. food labeling, traceability, and food-safety requirements.

Argan Oil: Address applicable FDA cosmetic and MoCRA requirements, including facility registration/product listing where required, responsible-person obligations, safety substantiation, ingredient labeling, and cosmetic labeling requirements.

A **licensed customs broker** will assist with HTS classification, customs entry, FDA coordination, duties, and potential preferential treatment under the **U.S.-Morocco Free Trade Agreement**.

Initial Launch

Begin with a small pilot rather than a container-sized order: approximately **200-500 bottles of olive oil** and **200-500 bottles of argan oil**. The pilot will validate the complete supply chain: **Moroccan Supplier -> Freight -> U.S. Customs/FDA -> U.S. Inventory -> Sales Channels -> Customer**. Before scaling, calculate true landed cost and contribution margin, including product, packaging, freight, customs, fulfillment, marketplace fees, advertising, shipping, and returns.

Sales & Growth Strategy

Channel	Approach
Direct-to-Consumer	Shopify website supported by social media and digital marketing.
Online Marketplaces	Amazon to test demand, pricing, reviews, and repeat purchases.
Wholesale	Olive oil: specialty groceries, Mediterranean/Middle Eastern markets, gourmet stores and restaurants. Argan oil: salons, spas, beauty stores and cosmetic retailers.

Scale & Long-Term Vision

Once demand and profitability are demonstrated, increase inventory to approximately **1,000-5,000+ units**, negotiate better supplier pricing, use larger and more economical freight shipments, establish 3PL fulfillment, and expand wholesale distribution. Over time, the company can add Moroccan products such as olives, preserved lemons, spices, prickly pear seed oil, rose water, rhassoul clay, and Moroccan black soap.

Immediate Objective: Establish the U.S. company and compliance infrastructure, successfully import the first commercial shipment, validate customer demand and profitability, and then scale the products with the strongest market potential.